Module 1
Topic: TED Talk
EPP-II
Communication Skills

TED Talks

TED is nonprofit organization that believes powerful ideas, when powerfully presented, move us to feel something, think differently and take action.

Ever wondered what makes a TED Talk so captivating that millions pause just to listen?

It’s not just the idea it’s how that idea is shared.

What is TED Talk:

A TED talk is a recorded public-speaking presentation that was originally given at the main TED (technology, entertainment and design) annual event or one of its many satellite events around the world.

TED is a nonprofit organization devoted to spreading ideas, usually in the form of short, powerful talks, often called "TED talks."

TED talks are made available on the TED website under a Creative Commons free license. They are also frequently featured via social media and multimedia sites like YouTube, Netflix, Facebook and LinkedIn.

Qualifications for a TED talk:

TED Talks are limited to a maximum of 18 minutes and may cover any topic of public interest.

TEDx website's explanation of selection criteria: "TED looks for engaging, charismatic speakers whose talks expose new ideas that are supported by concrete evidence and are relevant to a broad, international audience."

To apply to speak at a TED event, potential presenters must first submit a speaker nomination form. TED will then contact them if they are interested in having them speak.

Why TED Talk

TED is devoted to curiosity, reason, wonder and the pursuit of knowledge without an agenda. All who seek a deeper understanding of the world and connection with others are welcomed and invited to engage with ideas and activate them in the community.

The History of TED talks:

The TED organization was founded by Richard Saul Wurman, and the TED conference was co-founded by Harry Marks in February 1984.

The first TED conference was in 1984 and the conference has been held annually since 1990. Initially, the focus of TED conferences was technology, design and entertainment.

However, TED has broadened its focus in recent years to include big ideas on a wider range of topics such as global issues, business, education and health.

TED talks have been given by a variety of professionals from various fields of study, including actors, scientists, medical professionals and influencers.

Over the years, presenters of TED speakers have included notables Al Gore, Bill Clinton, Bill Gates, Bono, Jane Goodall, Malcolm Gladwell, Gordon Brown, Richard Dawkins, Mike Rowe, Larry Page, Sergey Brin and Vint Cerf among many others.

TED.com related projects:

In addition to TED talks, TED.com also has a number of other related projects and TED events. A few of them include:

- TEDx Talks are TED-like events that are organized by volunteers around the world.
- TED-Ed is a platform where educators can submit educational videos.
- TEDGlobal is an annual international conference that focuses on "ideas worth spreading."
- TEDTalks Director's Cut videos are select TED talks that have been remastered with new footage or animations.
- TEDWomen is an annual TED conference that focuses on "ideas worth spreading by women."
- TEDx in Schools is a program that brings TEDx events to schools.
- TED-Ed Clubs are after-school clubs for students who want to learn more about TED and TEDx Talks.
- The TED Prize is a $1 million prize awarded annually to "an exceptional individual with a creative, bold vision to spark global change." As of 2018, the TED Prize is now known as The Audacious Project.
- TED Fellows are "outstanding young innovators" who are selected each year. The TED Fellows Program provides "support, resources and access to the TED community."

How to Structure your TED Talk:

Structure isn't just about organization; it's about guiding the audience through a journey from curiosity to clarity, from emotion to inspiration.

1. **Start with a Powerful Hook (0–1 minute)**

The first few seconds decide whether the audience leans in or zones out. A strong opening might be:

- A thought-provoking question ("What if fear was actually our best teacher?")
- A personal moment ("Three years ago, I stood on a stage terrified and trembling…")
- A surprising fact ("By 2030, over half the world's jobs will require public speaking skills.") The goal is to ignite curiosity immediately. Keep it short, bold, and relevant to the main idea.

Cont…

2. **Introduce the Big Idea (1–2 minutes)**

Once attention is captured, the next step is to present the core concept what TED calls “an idea worth spreading.”
State it simply and clearly. Avoid overexplaining; the rest of the talk will unpack it.
For example- “My idea is simple: failure is not the opposite of success; it’s the foundation of it.”
This statement gives the audience a lens to view everything that follows.

3. **Tell a Relatable Story (2–8 minutes)**

The story forms the heart of the TED Talk. This is where emotion, vulnerability, and authenticity shine.
A well-written story helps the audience feel before they think. To make it impactful:

- Build tension (what went wrong or challenged the speaker).
- Add vivid detail (sights, sounds, emotions).
- End with a turning point or realisation.
- Tie the story back to the big idea.

For instance, a talk about courage might include a moment when the speaker almost gave up, but didn’t.

Cont…

4. **Present Insights and Lessons (8–12 minutes)**

Here comes the brain food the logic behind the story. Translate experience into insight:

- What did this story teach?
- How does it connect to something universal?
- What can the audience learn or apply?

Keep sentences crisp, avoid jargon, and use metaphors for complex ideas. The goal is not to sound smart, but to make the audience feel smarter.

5. **Reinforce with Data or Evidence (Optional)**

- A sprinkle of data or research adds credibility but moderation is key.
- Use one or two memorable facts, stories, or studies to strengthen your point. Example- “A Harvard study found that people who share personal stories are 22% more persuasive.”
- Make sure the evidence supports, not overshadows, your idea.

Cont…

6. **Deliver the Takeaway (12–15 minutes)**

Every TED Talk needs a moment where the message crystallizes a clear, actionable takeaway.

This might sound like- “The next time fear stops progress; remember it’s not your enemy; it’s your compass.” This line should summarize your big idea, evoke emotion and inspire reflection.

7. **End with a Resonant Closing (15–18 minutes)**

The closing is the echo the audience takes home. It should emotionally circle back to the beginning bringing the talk full circle. Try ending with:

- A callback to your opening story or question.
- A challenge (“So, what story will the world hear from you?”)
- A hopeful or poetic line that lingers in the listener’s mind.

Avoid ending abruptly with “thank you.” Instead, let your final words land.

Style & Delivery

- Speak naturally and confidently and avoid reading from a script.
- Use a conversational yet professional tone.
- Maintain good posture and make eye contact with the audience.
- Use hand gestures and movement to emphasize key points.
- Avoid excessive jargon; keep your language clear and accessible.

Cont…

Visual Aids & Supporting Materials (Optional)

- You may use slides, images, or props if they enhance your message.
- Keep slides minimal and avoid too much text. Use visuals to support, not overpower your talk.

Practice & Feedback

- Rehearse in front of a mirror, record yourself or practice with peers.
- Focus on voice modulation, pauses and expressions.

DIY Activity: Grab the Spotlight

Activity: Imagine that you have been invited to give a TED talk on the topic: ‘Renewable energy: Inevitable for Sustainability’.

Prepare a TED talk session considering the following points:

- **Introduction:** Start with a short story or something relatable that grabs the audience’s attention.
- **Main idea:** Explain what is Renewable energy and why it is inevitable for sustainability.
- **Personal Experience:** Share something that is personal and highlights the importance of Renewable energy.
- **Advice:** Give three ways humans can ensure the more Renewable sources of energy are used.
- **Conclusion:** End with a strong message and call to action.

Watch and Learn

1-https://youtu.be/wxStlzunxCw

2-https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mKZCa_ejbfg

3-https://www.ted.com/talks/bunker_roy_learning_from_a_barefoot_movement

4-https://www.google.com/search?client=firefox-b-d&q=Pranav+Mistry%27s+TED+Talk#fpstate=ive&vld=cid:4d2aba17,vid:YrtANPtnhyg,st:0

5-https://www.ted.com/talks/shashi_tharoor_why_nations_should_pursue_soft_power

6-https://www.google.com/search?client=firefox-b-d&q=+Manisha+Koirala%27s+TED+Talk#fpstate=ive&vld=cid:8a94ae13,vid:3nsPcBJAdxI,st:0